

FEMALE VEGETARIAN WEIGHT LOSS

Ch 1: Female Physiology

Women's bodies respond differently to diet and exercise due to monthly hormonal cycles, higher baseline fat storage requirements, and different muscle fibre composition. An effective female fat-loss plan accounts for these factors rather than fighting against them.

Physiological Difference	Impact on Fat Loss	Plan Adjustment
Higher oestrogen	Greater fat storage at hips, thighs, and glutes	Strength training to change body shape, not just scale weight
Monthly cycle	Energy and strength vary predictably by phase	Periodise training intensity and calories with the cycle
Lower testosterone	Slower muscle building than men	Higher relative protein; resistance training non-negotiable
Thyroid sensitivity	Metabolism adapts faster to caloric deficits	Maximum 400–500 kcal deficit; refeed weeks every 3–4 weeks
PCOS (10–20% of women)	Insulin resistance, irregular cycles, higher androgens	Lower-GI carbs; strength training; myo-inositol supplement

Ch 2: Cycle Syncing Training

Aligning training with your hormonal cycle leverages natural fluctuations to time hardest sessions when physiologically primed, and recovery sessions when the body needs restoration.

Phase	Days	Dominant Hormone	Training Style	Nutrition Adjustment
Menstrual	1–5	Low E + progesterone	Light: yoga, walk, gentle mobility	Warm iron-rich foods; extra magnesium
Follicular	6–13	Rising oestrogen	High intensity; best time for new PRs	Normal deficit; carbs around workouts
Ovulation	14	Oestrogen peak	Maximum strength and HIIT output	Maintenance calories; highest protein day
Luteal	15–28	Progesterone dominant	Moderate; reduce HIIT frequency	Add 150–200 kcal; expect 1–2 kg water weight

Ch 3: 12-Week Meal Plan

Calibrated for a 55–65 kg woman targeting 1,600–1,800 kcal/day with a 400–500 kcal deficit. All meals use Indian vegetarian ingredients available in any Indian kitchen or market.

Meal	Food	kcal	Protein
Breakfast 7 AM	3 moong dal chilla + green chutney + green chai (no sugar)	330	18g
Mid-morning 10 AM	1 cup low-fat curd + pomegranate seeds + 5 almonds	185	9g
Lunch 1 PM	1 cup rajma + 2 small roti + mixed sabzi + kachumber salad	420	20g
Pre-workout 4 PM	1 banana + 1 tsp peanut butter	200	4g
Post-workout 6 PM	50g soya chunks bhurji + 1 cup low-fat curd	250	28g
Dinner 8 PM	100g paneer bhurji + 1 roti + cucumber raita	370	24g
TOTAL		1,755 kcal	103g

Ch 4: 12-Week Training Programme

Phase	Weeks	Sessions/Week	Focus	Key Exercises
Foundation	1–3	3 full body + 2 cardio	Movement patterns; form mastery	Goblet squat, push-up, DB row, plank holds
Build	4–6	3 strength + 2 LISS	Progressive overload begins	DB squat, DB bench, lat pulldown, RDL
Sculpt	7–9	4 strength + 2 HIIT	Volume + targeted isolation	Barbell squat, bench, deadlift, glute work
Shred	10–12	5 sessions + 3 HIIT	Intensity maximisation	Full compound programme + finishers

Glute Development Protocol

Exercise	Sets x Reps	Key Cue	Progression
Hip thrust (barbell/band)	4 x 10–12	Squeeze glutes at top; 2-second hold	Add 2.5 kg when 12 reps clean
Romanian Deadlift	3 x 10–12	Push hips back; feel hamstring stretch	Add 2.5 kg weekly
Bulgarian Split Squat	3 x 10/side	Front foot forward; slight forward lean	Add DB when bodyweight is easy
Cable kickback	3 x 15/side	Extend at hip only; no knee swing	Increase cable weight monthly
Sumo squat	4 x 12	Toes out 45; sit back into hips	Add weight or goblet hold

Ch 5: Supplements for Indian Women

Supplement	Dose	Purpose	Cost/Month (approx)
Whey protein (vegetarian)	20–25g post-workout	Hit protein targets on veg diet	Rs 800–1500
Iron	18–27mg elemental	Prevent anaemia (esp. menstruation)	Rs 100–200
Vitamin D3 + K2	2000–5000 IU + 100mcg K2	Bone health, hormones, mood	Rs 150–300
Omega-3 algae-based	1–2g EPA+DHA	Anti-inflammatory; hormone balance	Rs 600–1200
Myo-Inositol (PCOS)	2–4g/day	Insulin sensitivity; menstrual regulation	Rs 400–800
Calcium + Magnesium	500mg Ca + 300mg Mg	Bone density, PMS reduction, sleep	Rs 200–400
Vitamin B12	500–1000 mcg	Essential; vegetarians commonly deficient	Rs 100–200

Ch 6: Mindset & Long-Term Success

Managing the Luteal Phase (Days 15–28) — When Willpower Feels Lowest

- Expect: increased appetite; 1–2 kg water weight gain; lower energy — all NORMAL
- Do not: crash diet, skip meals, punish yourself, or do extreme HIIT when exhausted
- Do: add 150–200 kcal of complex carbs; allow strength training; prioritise sleep 8+ hrs
- Remind yourself: scale weight increase is water/glycogen — your fat loss is still on track
- Track weekly averages, not daily weights — luteal fluctuations obscure real progress

12-Week Progress Metrics

- Body measurements (waist, hips, thighs) — more informative than scale alone for women
- Progress photos every 2 weeks: same lighting, clothing, and pose
- Strength benchmarks: hip thrust 1RM, squat, push-up reps — performance reflects recomp
- Energy levels, sleep quality, cycle regularity — hormonal health indicators
- Blood markers at 12 weeks: iron, D3, B12, fasting insulin, thyroid if symptomatic